story."

"Do it your way. You like mysteries. Put a murder in such a world and have a detective solve it with a robot partner. If the detective doesn't solve it, the robot will replace him."

That was the germ of a new novel I called The Caves of Steel.

When I wrote it, I did my best to ignore this business of robots replacing human beings. That was typically Gold and not at all Asimov —but Horace kept pushing, and in the end, some of it was forced in, though not nearly as much as Horace wanted.

What pleased me most about The Caves of Steel when I came to write it was that it was a pure murder mystery set against a science-fiction background. As far as I was concerned it was a perfect fusion of the two genre, and the first such perfect fusion. A number of people agree with me in this.

And on April 28, 1952, David's first tooth, the lower left front incisor, made its appearance through the gum.

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Of all the people in Breadloaf, I remembered John Ciardi most clearly. It had been my intention to return in 1951—I had half promised Fletcher Pratt I would—but during the last half of August, when the Breadloaf Writers Conference was always held, David was being born and I certainly couldn't leave then. So I had missed seeing John a second time.

However, he lived in a Boston suburb and was in publishing in a small way, having joined a publishing house called Twayne Press. He wanted stories for an anthology and I went to see him on April 30, and saw his brand-new, six-week-old daughter. Ciardi's wife, Judith, felt it was feeding time for the youngster, who was a breast baby. So she

pulled out a breast and handed it to the kid. Judith was always an entirely extroverted, unself-conscious, delightful person and this was quite in character—but I didn't know where to look.

I didn't sell John a story to anthologize but I initiated a friendship that was permanent.

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